

The GTA Rental Application Document Checklist

Everything a landlord or leasing agent in the Greater Toronto Area will realistically ask for — organized so your application looks complete the first time. General Ontario information, not legal advice.

1. Core Documents (required for every application)

- **Rental Application** — [Download the editable application here](#) and fill it out as fully and accurately as possible.
- **Credit Report & Score** — [Request your free Equifax credit report & score here](#) (free once per month via myEquifax).
- **Employment Letter** — on company letterhead, confirming your position, start date, and salary.
- **2–3 Recent Pay Stubs** — make sure your **annual salary** is shown on the stub, not just the pay-period amount.
- **References** — optional, but recommended. A previous landlord reference strengthens your application.

2. If Your Situation Isn't "Standard"

- **Self-employed:** pay stubs won't apply. Provide your **Notice of Assessment (NOA) from the previous year, plus proof of current income** (recent bank deposits, invoices, or contracts) — landlords want to see both your confirmed past income and your current earning ability.
- **New to Canada / no Canadian credit history yet:** a foreign passport plus your study or work permit is standard. Some landlords will ask for a larger deposit or a guarantor in place of Canadian credit history — this is common and not a reflection of your application quality.
- **Student:** a letter of acceptance or enrolment, plus a guarantor (often a parent) with their own proof of income, is the typical combination landlords expect.
- **Applying with roommates:** each applicant should bring their own full set of documents — landlords generally screen each person individually, even on a joint lease.

3. What Not to Send

Never send your SIN, banking passwords, or a full bank statement with account numbers visible unless you know exactly who is asking and why. A legitimate landlord or agent does not need these to assess a rental application. If something about a request feels off, it's reasonable to ask why it's needed before you send it.

4. One Quick Number Worth Knowing

Many landlords in the GTA use a rough guideline that rent shouldn't exceed about 30–35% of gross monthly income. It isn't a legal rule, and every landlord applies it differently, but knowing where you land against it before you apply can help you target listings where you're more likely to be approved.

Want a checklist built around your exact situation?

Key to GTA's free Rental Readiness tool matches your income, credit, and documents to a realistic list of areas and next steps — built on live GTA market data, not guesswork.

keytogta.ca

Prepared by Behzad Fard, Real Estate Agent, Property.ca Inc., Brokerage — RECO registered. General information only; this is not legal advice. For questions specific to your tenancy, consult the Landlord and Tenant Board (LTB) or a licensed paralegal/lawyer.